BIRINGAN CENTRAL BANK: OFFICE ORDER No. 2024-101

Subject: Foreign Travel Guidelines. SYNTHETIC DOCUMENT FOR TESTING: fictional organisation.

The following guidelines govern foreign travel of Biringan Central Bank (BCB) personnel who are authorised by the Foreign Travel Committee or the Governor to attend training or non-training events abroad ("official foreign travel assignment").

A. Coverage

These guidelines cover all BCB personnel, regardless of employment status, who are on an official foreign travel assignment. Domestic travel is governed by a separate issuance and is not covered by this Office Order.

B. Foreign Travel Committee

The Foreign Travel Committee (FTC) is chaired by the Head of the Corporate Services Sector. The FTC evaluates and approves proposals for participation of BCB personnel in official foreign travel assignments. The FTC is assisted by the FTC Technical Staff from the Learning and Development Department (LDD), which also qualifies the travel insurance companies that may insure BCB personnel on official foreign travel.

C. General Provisions

1. Budget. Foreign travel is charged to the travel budget of the traveller's Sector. No augmentation of the approved foreign travel budget is allowed. The Administrative Officer (AO) of the department confirms budget availability on the nomination form.

2. Expenses and allowances. BCB personnel are entitled to the per diem, daily transportation allowance, service fee, in and out allowance, representation allowance, hotel ceiling and clothing allowance in the BCB Travel Allowance Rates schedule. Where the organiser provides meals, accommodation or transport, BCB grants only the difference between the BCB entitlement and what the organiser provides.

3. Duration. The official travel period may start no earlier than one (1) day before and end no later than one (1) day after the event for destinations in Asia. For destinations in Europe, the Americas, the Middle East, Africa and Oceania, the official travel period may start up to two (2) days before and end up to two (2) days after the event.

4. Vacation leave. Filing of vacation leave abroad before the official travel is not allowed. Vacation leave abroad after the official travel is limited to a maximum of five (5) working days, subject to approval of the Department Head and the Sector Head. Any personal extension must be shown on the Foreign Travel Itinerary (Form TR-04) with the approved leave attached. Additional airfare or hotel cost caused by a personal extension is borne by the traveller.

5. Cancellation or failure to attend. If travel is cancelled or the participant fails to attend due to force majeure, safety and security risks, family emergencies, or medical conditions certified by the Medical Services Department, expenses already paid by the participant may be reimbursed upon presentation of documents, subject to the recommendation of the LDD and approval of the FTC Chairperson.

D. Training Events

1. Course duration. Foreign training must have at least three (3) training days per trip for North, South and Central America, Europe, the Middle East and Africa, and at least two (2) training days per trip for the rest of the world.

2. Eligibility for nomination. The nominee must: (a) hold a permanent appointment with at least two (2) years of continuous service in BCB; (b) have at least a Very Satisfactory performance rating for the last

two (2) rating periods; (c) have no pending administrative case; (d) be medically fit; (e) have no other approved foreign training in the same calendar year, unless the training is part of a modular or ladderised programme; and (f) have no pending post-training requirements with the LDD.

3. Service obligation. Personnel who complete a foreign training render a service obligation of six (6) months for a training of up to ten (10) days, and twelve (12) months for a training longer than ten (10) days. Failure to complete the training or the service obligation requires refund of the training expenses.

E. Non-Training Events

Non-training events include meetings, working groups, conferences, fora, speaking engagements, and supervisory or due-diligence visits. Participation in non-training events is approved by the Deputy Governor. Speaking engagements for private organisers are approved only if transportation and accommodation are shouldered by the organiser, at no cost to BCB.

F. Travel Arrangements

1. Arrangements by the traveller. Personnel arrange their own airfare quotations, airline tickets and visa application forms. With the help of the LDD, they secure an appointment with the Department of Foreign Affairs (DFA) for the issuance of the official (red) passport and the note verbale needed for the visa application.

2. Airline tickets. Three (3) airfare quotations with identical flight details, together with a certification that the route is the most direct and economical, are required for every ticket.

3. Booking class. Personnel below the rank of Director travel in economy class. Directors may travel in premium economy for flights with a scheduled duration longer than eight (8) hours. Deputy Governors and the Governor may travel in business class.

4. Travel insurance. All personnel on official foreign travel must obtain travel insurance only from an insurer qualified by the LDD, with medical coverage of at least USD 50,000 for the whole official travel period.

ANNEX A: Procedures

A. Training events (activity, then who is in charge)

1. Nominate a qualified employee. In charge: Nominating department.

2. Verify availability of budget with the Administrative Officer; the AO indicates it on the nomination form. In charge: Nominating department / AO.

3. Submit to the LDD, at least fifteen (15) working days before the organiser's registration deadline: (a) the organiser's invitation or brochure; (b) the accomplished External Training Nomination Form (Form LD-01) noted by the Sector Head; and (c) the Certificate of No Pending Administrative Case from Legal Services. In charge: Nominating department.

4. Evaluate and endorse qualified nominees to the FTC. In charge: LDD.

5. Act on the nomination. In charge: FTC.

6. Prepare the Foreign Travel Authority (FTA). In charge: LDD.

7. Sign the FTA. In charge: Sector Head.

8. Submit the notarised Deed of Undertaking (Form LD-07) to the LDD within five (5) working days after being informed of the approved FTA. In charge: Participant.

9. Release the original approved FTA and the Medical Clearance Request (Form MS-03) to the participant. In charge: LDD.

10. Obtain three (3) airfare quotations, book the airline ticket and prepare the visa application; with the LDD, set the DFA appointment for the official (red) passport and the note verbale. In charge: Participant / LDD.

11. Obtain travel insurance from an LDD-qualified insurer. In charge: Participant.

12. Submit the approved Request for Fund Advance (Form AC-11) and Disbursement Voucher (Form AC-02) to the Accounting Department at least seven (7) working days before departure. In charge: Participant / AO.

13. Take the medical clearance at the Medical Services Department within fourteen (14) calendar days before departure and submit it to the AO. In charge: Participant.

14. After the training, submit to the LDD within forty-five (45) calendar days the Learning Assessment Form (Form LD-12), the training materials and the echo-session certification. In charge: Participant.

15. Submit the documents for liquidation of the cash advance or for reimbursement to the Accounting Department within thirty (30) calendar days after return. In charge: Participant.

B. Non-training events

1. Submit to the Office of the Deputy Governor, at least five (5) working days before the event, the organiser's invitation and a memorandum proposal noted by the Sector Head. In charge: Nominating department.

2. After approval, the nominating department prepares the FTA. Steps 9 to 15 of the training procedure apply, except that no Deed of Undertaking and no Learning Assessment Form are required.